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Question **1**

Not answered

Marked out of 1

The term Quality Improvement in the context of healthcare refers to which of the following?

Select one:

- ☐ Approaches to ensure quality and safety of health services
- ☐ Studies that reflect on a professional's practice and approach to medicine
- ☐ Projects that measure and monitor the outcome of clinical care
- ☐ Systematic approach to reduce waste and minimise resource consumption
- ☐ Evaluation strategies focused on adverse events

Your answer is incorrect.

Quality Improvement is a scientific approach to tackle the challenge of ensuring quality and safety of healthcare provision. QI method includes both systematic analysis of performance and interventions to improve it.

The correct answer is: Approaches to ensure quality and safety of health services

Question 2

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following differentiates a quality improvement project from a research project?

Select one:

- ☐ Quality Improvement projects provide insights that can be widely applied to other services
- ☐ Quality Improvement projects aim to create new knowledge about a local service
- ☐ Quality Improvement projects do not evaluate clinical interventions
- ☐ Quality Improvement is an aspect of clinical governance
- ☐ Interventions tested in Quality Improvement projects are not novel

Your answer is incorrect.

It is important to note that QI projects are fundamentally similar to scientific research projects in health care. PDSA involves prediction of the outcome of a test of change (hypothesis statement) and subsequent measurement over time (quantitative or qualitative measurement) to assess the impact of an intervention (experimental manipulation) on the process or outcomes of interest. But in QI projects, the tested interventions are within established standards of care.

The correct answer is: Interventions tested in Quality Improvement projects are not novel

Question 3

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following provides a method for structuring iterative development of change as part of wider quality improvement approaches in health services?

Select one:

- ☐ Focus groups
- ☐ Analytical epidemiology
- ☐ PDSA cycles
- ☐ Second generation epidemiological studies
- ☐ Surveys

Your answer is incorrect.

PDSA is often the central component of QI initiatives. PDSA stands for Plan-Do-Study-Act cycle. Most often in healthcare, ideas are introduced top-down without adequate evaluation. PDSA cycles provide means to integrate top-down ideas with bottom-up observations before implementation. PDSA allows us to test an idea by temporarily trialling a change and assessing its impact. The PDSA method originates from quality improvement studies in the industry. Shewhart and Deming initially described iterative processes that eventually became known as the four stages of PDSA.

The correct answer is: PDSA cycles

Question 4

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following methods of quality improvement focuses only on retrospective evaluation?

Select one:

- ☐ Six Sigma Model
- ☐ PDSA cycle
- ☐ Root cause analysis
- ☐ Benefit Realisation Plan
- ☐ Failure Mode and effects analysis

Your answer is incorrect.

Root cause analysis (RCA) is a well-established QI method, though some argue that it is mostly a Quality Assurance process that QI. RCA involves a retrospective investigation that occurs after a sentinel event (usually an adverse event e.g. an inpatient suicide). RCA aims to identify the putative fundamental reasons (casual factors) explaining variation in performance that resulted in the sentinel event. RCA focusses on individual events and suffers from hindsight bias, wherein findings may apply only to the specific event and not to the system as a whole

The correct answer is: Root cause analysis

Question 5

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following methods of quality improvement is based on 80/20 rule of management?

Select one:

- ☐ Pareto Chart
- ☐ PDSA cycle
- ☐ Six Sigma Model
- ☐ Statistical Process Chart
- ☐ Benefit Realisation Plan

Your answer is incorrect.

A Pareto chart is nothing but a bar chart but the bars are reorganised to show the categories with most frequent showing events on the left and the least frequent to the right. Sometimes a line showing cumulative frequency is also superimposed. A Pareto chart helps us to visualise the high-yield events, which when focussed upon, can result in maximum improvement. (This charting follows the 80/20 economic principle. 80% of the income of a nation generally goes only to 20% of the population. By focusing on the 20% of high-impact circumstances, nearly 80% of problems can be managed).

The correct answer is: Pareto Chart

Question 6

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following refers to Quality Improvement activity?

Select one:

- ☐ Identifying the staff member who divulged information about a patient in the maternity ward following a bogus call from a reporter
- ☐ Identifying whether the doctors or nurses that were at fault after an inpatient suicide
- ☐ Evaluating the adverse events arising from a new drug introduced in the local formulary
- ☐ Evaluating whether a community team setting encourages clinicians to report errors
- ☐ Evaluating the number of times breaches in confidentiality occurred when answering telephone queries

Your answer is incorrect.

Quality Improvement involves both prospective and retrospective evaluation strategies that are aimed at improvement. QI specifically focuses on determining 'what will work better', avoiding blame attribution, and to create systems to prevent rather than rectify errors.

The correct answer is: Evaluating whether a community team setting encourages clinicians to report errors

Question 7

Not answered

Marked out of 1

In quality improvement projects, the term PDCA refers to

Select one:

- ☐ Plan-Do-Check-Act
- ☐ Plan-Do-Control-Act
- ☐ Plan-Do-Collect-Act
- ☐ Plan-Do-Study-Act
- ☐ Plan-Do-Collaborate-Act

Your answer is incorrect.

The term PDCA (plan –do –check –act) is sometimes used interchangeably with PDSA. But PDCA is best reserved for using in the context of error correction or fault detection rather than QI.

The correct answer is: Plan-Do-Check-Act

Question 8

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Reducing waste is a critical part of which of the following models of quality improvement?

Select one:

- ☐ PDSA cycle
- ☐ Lean Thinking
- ☐ FADE model
- ☐ Failure Mode and effects analysis
- ☐ Benefit Realisation Plan

Your answer is incorrect.

Lean Thinking is a management philosophy focussed on 4 features (1) preserving value by identifying the value stream (2) reducing resource consumption by enabling process and value flow (3) reducing waste and developing pull systems (4) improving overall user satisfaction by pursuing perfection. Several retail and customer service industries have adopted this philosophy successfully in times of financial constraints.

The correct answer is: Lean Thinking

Question 9

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following is a consensus checklist recommended when reporting formal studies of healthcare quality improvement?

Select one:

- ☐ ENHANCE
- ☐ PRISMA
- ☐ MOOSE
- ☐ SQUIRE
- ☐ STARD

Your answer is incorrect.

The Standards for Quality Improvement Reporting Excellence (SQUIRE statement) consists of a 19 items checklist recommended when reporting formal studies of healthcare quality improvement (Ogrinc et al., 2008).

The correct answer is: SQUIRE

Question 10

Not answered

Marked out of 1

There is robust evidence to suggest that the efficacy of tamoxifen reduces when used in combination with fluoxetine. A project was designed across two GP practices in Bristol to identify affected patients and implement a change. A search was conducted to find all those on tamoxifen and fluoxetine, using the computerised patient registry. Identified patients were then contacted to discuss the evidence before recommending a change of antidepressant. Furthermore, a presentation was given to all GPs at the two surgeries alerting them to the new guidelines. A message was also set up to flash on the computer system whenever an attempt was made to co-prescribe the two drugs. This project is best described as a

Select one:

- ☐ Case series
- ☐ Cohort study
- ☐ Qualitative study
- ☐ Quality improvement study
- ☐ Case control study

Your answer is incorrect.

Quality Improvement is a formal approach to the analysis of performance (in this case, the prescribing practice of 2 GP surgeries) and systematic efforts to improve it (recalling patients, providing information and changing practice).

<http://qir.bmj.com/content/2/1/u201015.w675.full>

The correct answer is: Quality improvement study



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